Unit 3

Understanding Disaster



Learning Objectives

- To understand the meaning of disaster.
- To know about the types of disasters.
- To know a few key concepts in Disaster Management and orient them to the words used in media.
- To understand Tsunami and flood.
- To understand about Forecasting, Emergency Operation Centre etc.,

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This lesson explains about the various natural disasters and man-made disasters. It also deals with the precautionary and mitigation measures taken to avoid the loss of lives and materials.

Disaster is a very common phenomenon in the human society. It has been experienced by people since time immemorial. Though its form may be varied, it has been a challenge for society. The latest development which has been discovered in the World Disaster Reports recently is that, the disasters have increased in frequency and intensity. India is one of the most disaster prone countries in the world. It has some of the world's most severe droughts, famines, cyclones, earthquakes, chemical disasters, rail accidents and road accidents. The high density of population in the developing countries, especially in the high risk coastal areas, results in millions of people getting affected by natural disasters, especially in recurring disasters like floods, cyclones, storm surges, etc.

Disaster

'A disaster is a serious disruption of the functioning of a society involving human and material loss. Disaster is broadly classified into natural and man-made disasters.

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